

Most Asked Interview Questions

Here are 15 advanced DAX interview questions and answers based on real-world business scenarios.

1. Q: How do you calculate Sales for the previous year?

Scenario: Management wants to compare this year's sales with the previous year.

Sales_PY = CALCULATE([Total Sales],
SAMEPERIODLASTYEAR('Date'[Date]))

2. Q: How do you calculate Year-over-Year (YoY) growth in revenue?

Scenario: Financial reporting requires YoY performance analysis.

YoY Growth = DIVIDE([Total Sales] - [Sales_PY], [Sales_PY])

3. Q: How can you apply filters to a measure using CALCULATE?

Scenario: Marketing wants to know sales only from the "West" region.

West Sales = CALCULATE([Total Sales], 'Region'[Region] = "West")

4. Q: How do you calculate cumulative (running total) sales?

Scenario: Sales team wants a monthly running total on dashboards.

Cumulative Sales = CALCULATE([Total Sales],
FILTER(ALLSELECTED('Date'[Date]), 'Date'[Date] <= MAX('Date'[Date])))

5. Q: How do you find the second highest selling product?

Scenario: Operations wants to identify alternative best-sellers.

Second Highest Sales =

CALCULATE(
MAXX(
FILTER(

```

        ALL('Product'),
        [Total Sales] < CALCULATE(MAX([Total Sales]))
    ),
    [Total Sales]
)
)

```

6. Q: How do you create a dynamic measure that updates based on slicer selection (e.g., Month)?

Scenario: Users want the report to change based on slicer inputs.

Selected Month Sales = CALCULATE([Total Sales], 'Date'[Month] = SELECTEDVALUE('Date'[Month]))

7. Q: How do you predict next month's sales based on a simple average?

Scenario: Forecasting for inventory planning.

Predicted Sales = AVERAGEX(
 LASTN(3, ORDERBY('Date', 'Date'[Date], DESC)),
 [Total Sales]
)

8. Q: How do you create a flag for whether a customer is "New" or "Returning"?

Scenario: Marketing segmentation.

Customer Type =

```

IF(
    CALCULATE(COUNTROWS('Sales'), FILTER(ALL('Sales'),
'Sales'[CustomerID] = EARLIER('Sales'[CustomerID]) && 'Sales'[OrderDate]
< EARLIER('Sales'[OrderDate])))) > 0,
    "Returning",
    "New"
)

```

9. Q: How do you calculate the number of business days between two dates?

Scenario: SLA (Service Level Agreement) tracking.

Business Days =

```
CALCULATE(  
    COUNTROWS('Date'),  
    'Date'[IsWorkingDay] = TRUE(),  
    DATESBETWEEN('Date'[Date], [Start Date], [End Date])  
)
```

10. Q: How do you find the first purchase date for each customer?

Scenario: Customer lifecycle analysis.

First Purchase Date =

```
CALCULATE(MIN('Sales'[OrderDate]), ALLEXCEPT('Sales',  
'Sales'[CustomerID]))
```

11. Q: How do you calculate average order value (AOV)?

Scenario: E-commerce metrics.

AOV = DIVIDE([Total Sales], [Total Orders])

12. Q: How do you find the top 3 performing categories by sales?

Scenario: Merchandising decision support.

Top 3 Category Sales =

```
IF(  
    RANKX(ALL('Category'), [Total Sales], , DESC) <= 3,  
    [Total Sales]  
)
```

13. Q: How do you calculate sales only for the current quarter?

Scenario: Quarterly business reviews.

Current Quarter Sales =

```
CALCULATE([Total Sales], DATESINPERIOD('Date'[Date],  
MAX('Date'[Date]), -3, MONTH))
```

14. Q: How do you exclude a specific product or region in your calculation?

Scenario: Outlier product skewing trends.

Sales Excluding Product A =

```
CALCULATE([Total Sales], 'Product'[ProductName] <> "Product A")
```

15. Q: How do you calculate sales for the same period last year, but only if data exists (handle missing data)?

Scenario: Avoiding NULL in sparse datasets.

Safe Sales PY =

```
IF(  
    ISBLANK([Sales_PY]),  
    BLANK(),  
    [Sales_PY]  
)
```

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